

f mind" is allowed to become the design team all-remote mantra, morale will suffer. To celebrate accomplishments and enhance team cohesiveness, design teams should implement visual reminders of milestones, shortcomings, challenges, learnings, and expectations. If possible, they should track all-remote metrics and performance against previous traditional work environment metrics and performance. When metrics from both environments are juxtaposed, the team can see and thus manage productivity changes. Consider asking questions like: Is a team member distancing themselves from the team? Has a team member changed the way they communicate? Has anyone's work output significantly changed in recent times?

1. Flexibility and Improvement Model: Out of the gate, few design teams will operate at peak capacity in a newly remote environment. For this reason, it's important to remain flexible and allow systems to take hold. Whenever possible, team leaders should highlight individual and team successes, underscore positive metrics, and feature major project achievements to bolster morale and show what's possible. Design team leaders must be willing to ask penetrating questions about what's working and what isn't in order to effectively change models, adjust trajectories and improve performance.

### Prioritizing initiatives

Mature design teams will likely already leverage a series of communications tools so a sudden shift to an all-remote arena will not impact digital communications much. However, teams with an established collaborative cadence may find the shift to an all-remote environment challenging due to the absence of in-person brainstorming, iterative design sessions, visual feedback and mark-up meetings. Therefore, design teams should prioritize this element to ensure appropriate collaboration measures are put in place immediately so that no one on the team goes off on their own, unlinked from the greater team's efforts.

### Tools to make the change

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Key tools and technologies needed to make the shift from in-person to all-remote collaboration among designers, product managers, engineers, and any other stakeholders include:

- Instant Messaging tools (e.g. Slack, MS Teams) to maintain the velocity of design and development
- Concepting/sketching tools (e.g. Mural, Miro, InVision's Freehand, Figma, Apple iPod/Pencil) for real-time brainstorming or sketching sessions
- Cloud-based planning and documentation platform (e.g. GitLab)
- Research and feedback platforms to validate designs (e.g. usertesting.com, Validately)

### Tips for getting started

Each team's transition to remote work will look different. Here are some tips and practical advice start with:

1. Open edits on all platforms: Lacking face-to-face interactions demands more transparency in digital feedback systems. Defer to "open for edits" in all platforms to allow team members opportunities to chime in on projects. Realize that time shifts for individual team members vary.

1. More frequent accountability check ins: Recognize that there are no longer any "water cooler" conversations and that "managing by walking around" requires a different route, different tool, and different set of expectations. Those short, quick but productive conversations will not exist any longer so it's important to replicate them through other means as much as possible. Set up open chat rooms or perhaps schedule several few minute breaks where invited team members can check in at particular times during the day.
1. Embrace experimentation: Innovation is borne of necessity and nothing creates more need for innovation than unexpected or even unimagined challenges. Request feedback from team members on new and better ways to communicate, collaborate and increase the velocity of project work. While feedback cycles may be slow initially when first going all remote, design team leaders should continue to implement and demand robust feedback loops.
1. Block time: In all-remote environments, team members will likely rely on email and chat more than before. As such, it's important to allow teams to block "work time" to avoid more frequent interruptions. Example: No emails or phone calls between 10:30 am and 2:30 pm.
1. Document everything: In a traditional environment, documentation becomes second nature. In a suddenly all-remote environment, the need to document and over-communicate everything becomes paramount.
1. Get together: An all-remote work environment does not mean an always-remote work environment. It's important for team members to interact with each other in person, even if only annually. Consider hosting an in-person retreat for team members for this purpose.

### The upside of disruption

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Disruptions can cause consternation and unease, but there's a flip side as well. Below are three fundamental benefits from shifting to an all-remote environment, especially if that shift happens suddenly.

1. Innovation: As we have seen with the recent pandemic, when companies are forced to rethink their processes and deal with unforeseen circumstances, it leads to innovation. For design teams that are populated by creative individuals, the birth of innovation is especially true.
1. Productivity: In the short term, as individuals settle into their new work environments, it's possible productivity might take a dip. After all, having to deal with issues like setting up a remote office, adjusting for remote security policies, and finding ways to work in a busy home with family and pets around can cause some hiccups. The research, however, shows that individuals are far more productive when they are allowed the flexibility and the opportunity to do their jobs without unnecessary interruptions in traditional work environments. This is particularly true for design teams which often suffer from an interrupt-driven culture that can impinge upon the ability to effectively create and finish work product. With these distractions removed, design team members often report higher levels of employee satisfaction.
1. Loyalty: When trust is given to employees, loyalty is returned. Individuals appreciate it when their employers trust them to do their jobs and give them the tools to do so. It creates a different type of bond, separate and apart from the "check-in" culture that often accompanies typical work environments.

### Understanding impact

As design teams move to an all-remote environment, it's important to double down on effort to

engage with other departments, e.g. finance, people operations, marketing, sales, etc. What once was taken for granted as every day interactions must now be purposely built into interdepartmental communications. To the extent possible, design team leaders should implement 360 degree feedback loops among key stakeholders in other departments to ensure smooth, efficient operations.

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## SECTION: company/culture/all-remote/guide/finance.md

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Check any online job board and you will find thousands of companies recruiting for finance professionals to work remotely. Like their counterparts in other parts of enterprises, CFOs and their direct managers understand the importance of recruiting the best and brightest finance professionals and then finding ways to integrate them into the company fully. On-premise finance work as the norm is today less important than a fully prepared, flexible and resilient finance team ready, willing and able to work in an all-remote way.

### Calculating sudden all-remote preparedness

Many organizations have already discovered their finance groups can function quite well remotely. According to an Owl Labs survey, approximately 7% of finance/legal professionals work remotely. If your company had not previously dipped its toe into remote-work waters, COVID-19 "work from home" directives likely required your company to implement some or all of the following strategies:

1. Move away from or fully off on-premise technology: The ability of a Finance team's members to access what is needed remotely minimally means accessing on-premise solutions via VPN, along with being well-equipped with the commensurate equipment to have a fully functioning workstation. A heavier lift is making the move to the cloud. In times of disruption, Finance can induce a sense of calm across an organization by operating with fewer (or without) hiccups.
1. Go paperless: Save time from having to shred. Make sure the Systems team backs everything up. Twice. You can do it. Thrust suddenly into an all-remote scenario, paper files will be your Achilles heel, as they will immediately become inaccessible if you didn't take them with you when the doors to the office shut behind you.
1. Communication Tools: Organizations that permit the use of a multitude of varying tools for collaboration to accomplish the same things-voice, video conferencing, chat, file sharing-permit confusion to creep in. All-remote productivity can be increased by using a finite set of company sanctioned tools. Further, a minimal set of tools ensures remote or asynchronous communication remains clear, focused and consistent, curbing loss of productivity. Minimize email for the sake of more immediate responses and feedback. Now that you've identified the right company communication tools, use them! Especially early on in a sudden onset all-remote environment, frequent synchronous/real-time communication is key to gauging how your coworkers or those who report to you are doing. Simply put, people handle stressful events very differently.

1. Flexibility with Shifting Schedules: With a company's new "everyone at home" dynamic, an adjustment period is necessary due to the simple fact that personal and business lives are far more acutely intermingled than before. Finance teams are not immune to this and a new paradigm of shifting schedules becomes the new norm. This forces teams to prioritize tasks and deliverables. Leaders need to keep a sense of routine, but, at the same time, be flexible as the dust settles into new patterns and the team finds its new rhythm.

1. Transparency: Transparency in a remote Finance team builds trust and confidence across the group. Some highly remote companies share everything across the board to everyone, except salaries, and some even share that info as company-wide policy. The tendency is for the workforce to embrace their lane and know how they fit in the construct of the team and the business as a whole. Information and access flows much more freely within transparent organizations, democratizing access while maintaining control. It also allows team members to view each other as partners rather than pegs in a hierarchical structure. Team members need to be intentional about relationships with their colleagues.

1. Automate: If transactions, invoicing, reporting, etc. can be automated, automate it. It frees up the team to work towards greater business goals, and encourages them to expand their vision into other areas that might otherwise suffer from inattention. It enables a Finance team to stay lean and nimble and keep the team's collective eyes on results.

Tools to make the change

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Key tools and technologies needed to make the shift from in-person to all-remote collaboration for Finance teams might include:

- Synchronous messaging tools (e.g. Slack, Microsoft Teams, IRC, etc.) to maintain velocity through real-time interaction and collaboration;
- Document sharing (Google Drive, Box, Dropbox, etc.)
- SaaS-based accounting software solutions (ADP, Quickbooks, etc.)
- Video conferencing (e.g. Zoom, Skype, Google Meet) for synchronous discussions with recording for later viewing by those who could not attend; and
- Cloud-based planning and documentation platform (e.g. GitLab).

Checks and balances

In order for a Finance team to run well after being suddenly dropped into working all-remote, it bears repeating that it's not for everyone. Human beings are social creatures after all. Be mindful of the following pitfalls your group may encounter when making the shift, forced or not:

1. Lack of face-to-face supervision means team members may not speak up as quickly when they encounter a challenge or block. Check in more regularly with your supervisor and those who report to you - at least until your team has its rhythm down. Managers who go "invisible" run the risk of having their employees feel that the manager is out of touch with employee needs.

1. Without routine communication, especially if coupled with a lack of access to information, team members lower their willingness to give others the benefit of the doubt. Taking extra time to listen rather than just talking at other team members is really important to keep the business culture buoyed and to ensure that top priorities are handled first.

1. On a more practical note, human and technical errors with the tools utilized for working remotely may be a real challenge resulting in unnecessary delays. This is especially a challenge if an employee is not technically inclined. Even the most well-intentioned shifts in the right direction to working productively while remote can backfire or may not have been fully analyzed. Some key automation may not exist yet or that paperwork you really need may not have been scanned into the system.

1. Experiment: Request daily feedback from Finance team members on new and better ways to communicate, collaborate and increase the velocity of project work. While feedback cycles may slow initially when going all remote, finance team leaders should implement and demand robust feedback loops.

1. Block time: In all-remote environments, finance team members will likely rely on email and chat more than before. As such, it's important to allow finance teams to block "work time" to avoid more frequent interruptions. Example: No emails or phone calls between 10:30 am and 2:30 pm.

1. Document everything: In a traditional environment, documentation becomes second nature. In a suddenly all-remote environment, the need to document and over-communicate everything becomes paramount.

1. Get together: An all-remote work environment does not mean an always-remote work environment. It's important for finance team members to interact with each other in person, even if only annually. Find ways to host a retreat for team members for this purpose.

### The upside of disruption

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As companies evolve to being able to shift to an all-remote setting on the fly, naturally their outlook about conducting business more routinely in a remote setting will also change. With that comes a number of great perks to their bottom line:

1. Talent Acquisition and hiring: Remote work environments open up greater access to talent because there are no longer any geographical restraints to hiring. Additionally, not only does the talent pool get expanded because of lack of geographical constraints, but also because today's workforce actively seeks more flexible work environments. Consequently and especially if a company is based in a high-cost urban location, hires can be made for significantly less money than local talent would require.

1. Workdays extend across time zones: The company can gain better coverage/distribution so work happens more consistently throughout the day, rather than being focused into a tighter window of hours.

1. Insulation against localized failures: Furthermore, a company's ability to weather localized infrastructure failures like power outages, internet disruptions, natural disasters, etc. and business continuity plans improve if the workforce is dispersed geographically.

1. Lower overhead: More remote workers means less need to maintain commercial office space lowering overhead costs.

### Bottom line

This guide will help Finance teams discover a natural rhythm to operating in a suddenly remote way. This rhythm will allow teams to identify key priorities, manage them effectively, and learn from their implementation in an iterative fashion, further informing the next priority

tier as appropriate. As in any professional environment, open communications about learning as you make your way is essential.

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## SECTION: company/culture/all-remote/guide/legal.md

## Introduction

We are building a remote guide for legal teams, which will be added to this page soon. Pending legal review, of course.

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## SECTION: company/culture/all-remote/guide/people-operations.md

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Perhaps more than any other functional department, people operations · referred to as "human resources," "HR," "people success," or simply "people" across various organizations · is front and center in helping shape and optimize the changes required when a sudden shift to an all-remote environment becomes necessary. This guide outlines how people teams might navigate the sudden shift to an all-remote work environment, what challenges are most important to tackle, and how the new normal can unveil unforeseen benefits.

## Related resources

- 1. Remote onboarding
- 1. Building culture
- 1. Hiring
- 1. Compensation and Total Rewards
- 1. Remote internships

## Major strategic considerations

As with any new initiative, thinking and operating strategically is important for success. Maintaining company values, ensuring clear communication guidelines, and supporting managers and team members through the transition are essential to making the shift seamless. Here are some strategic considerations to evaluate during your planning stage:

- 1. Cultural and Values Equivalence: The sudden shift to an all-remote environment requires a smooth transition on the culture front. Whatever your organization's culture and values were

before the immediate shift, they should remain so after. For example, if your organization operates in self-directed work teams, the suddenly all-remote standards should remain the same. Significant changes in how you operate may be inferred by team members as a lack of trust which can be difficult to reverse.

1. Empathy and Understanding: Sudden shifts also cause anxiety, concerns, and a level of unease for many people uncomfortable with change. Given this fact, it's important for people teams to inject into their everyday management systems ways to check on team members' progress, offer assistance, provide guidance and demonstrate empathy more frequently than they would have otherwise. In a colocated work environment, people professionals can visually inspect colleagues. When this no longer exists, it's critical to find flexible ways to enable the organisation to check in and deal with the suddenly remote workforce. Empathy, grace, and understanding go a long way to helping maintain and reinforce bonds with team members.

1. Manage to Milestones: People departments should work with other leaders in the organization to ensure a clear definition of milestones and metrics. Be careful not to equate "time worked" with value-delivered. Instead, manage results and behaviors. If results suffer, then probe to uncover the reasons, recognizing that there might be a logical reason for a dip. Importantly, take special care to recognize and reward results or behaviors that spur better than expected results or performance. Highlighting success is just as important · if not more so · in a suddenly all-remote situation as it is in more traditional environments.

1. Fundamentals: It's easy to assume suddenly remote team members have all the pieces in place in their home to work productively. That would be a mistake. Survey team members immediately as to their work-set up and urgent needs, e.g. a good desk chair, secure Internet connection, headphones for video conferences, etc. To the extent possible, offer to reimburse them for reasonable home office equipment.

1. Encourage Flexibility and Innovation: A simple "copy/paste" of a traditional work environment into a suddenly all-remote one may sound good in theory but counterproductive in practice. Encourage team members to adjust work schedules and processes to reflect the newly all-remote arena, and recognize those with the most innovative applications. Again, do not set the productivity bar low; rather push for and call out those who are making a "good thing" better.

1. Over-Communicate: Communication is vital in any business. In a suddenly all-remote situation, diligent documentation is a requirement. A handbook for documentation acts as a single source of truth for information making it possible for team members to get what they need the minute they need it. Weekly 1:1 meetings will keep you connected and checking in regularly, and team stand-ups and/or end-of-day sessions can provide structure to the team. The goal of adding these extra communication hooks is not to hover but to empower self-sufficiency as much as possible.

1. Emphasize the Human Element in HR: Productivity spawns from people able to perform their jobs with minimal distractions. In a suddenly all-remote environment, this may be problematic. Leaders must understand that people's lives are complex, and team members may be juggling childcare, eldercare, community efforts, and beyond. parents if schools and daycares are closed. Recognize personal needs, and bend expectations accordingly. Consider implementing team breaks, e.g. a daily walkabout, or some other non-traditional activity that underscores your commitment to team members' well being.

Embrace agility and remain flexible

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As with any significant change, emphasize flexibility. When setting up an all-remote work environment, hiccups are natural and should be expected. The shift requires time to flush out what's working and what isn't. Remaining agile in the face of these evolving realities is essential to course-correcting trajectories. Let team members know that change is a constant, that adjustments will reflect reality on the ground and no set of initial rules are set in stone or sacrosanct. To accomplish this, find ways to leverage the following elements of a solid internal communications strategy:

1. Internal social networks, like Slack, which allow for more rapid communication across teams. Monthly email updates are fine, but business moves too quickly to rely on infrequent communications.
1. A culture of engagement that encourages everyone to participate in key initiatives. Research conducted by Aon Hewitt found that a 5% increase in team member engagement led to a 3% increase in revenue the following year. What might be perceived as a soft skill is, in fact, a bottom line driver.
1. Engaging, visually-stimulating content that's easy to absorb, share, and retain. Forego the long, legalistic policy memos in favor of more compelling and memorable content. And don't worry if the videos are not professionally produced; we're used to various quality of content.
1. Customized communications based on departments, teams, and individuals. The more focused the communications, the better.
1. Frequent, visible recognition of success, especially in the face of challenging circumstances.
1. Even in fully asynchronous environments where people are not required to adhere to certain work hours, remember that time zones do exist and should be respected. Additionally, a global team may cross many time zones, and remote team members may move from one time zone to another as they travel.

#### Tools to make the change

Key tools and technologies needed to make the shift from in-person to all-remote collaboration among team members include:

1. Instant messaging tools (e.g. Slack, Microsoft Teams) to maintain regular contact
1. Video conferencing (e.g. Zoom, Skype, Google Meet) for virtual touchpoints
1. Cloud-based planning and documentation platform (e.g. GitLab)
1. Learning management system tool to enable remote training
1. Document management tool to allow remote signatures
1. Integration between your ATS, HRIS and payroll systems to create a fluid workflow experience

#### Direct impact on people team members

The impact of any sudden change to people operations will fall unequally on team members. Given this, consider the following as you build, implement and tweak your road map:

1. Building Culture: An organization's culture should be built, nurtured, and amplified intentionally, not by accident. The same applies in a suddenly all-remote environment. Sure, the way work gets done will change, but that doesn't mean the culture should. Instead, it's critical to intentionally shift and project the company's culture in an all-remote arena, emphasizing it over and over. See this review on building and sustaining an intentional remote culture.



1. Self-learning and self-enabled environment: Whenever a new hire brings up a valid process point that leads to a previously undocumented answer, the default mindset should be to answer and document right away. This requires a mindset of self-service, self-searching, and self-learning. It also requires diligence and empathy. This is a critical part of reinforcing a bias for asynchronous and a culture where every meeting is questioned.

1. Onboarding: Time spent developing and honing your onboarding process in traditional work environments should be followed as much as possible in the suddenly all-remote environment to ensure that each new employee experiences the full impact of joining the organization. Avoid shortcuts if possible. See this detailed review of onboarding in a remote environment.

1. Hiring: Being thrust into an all-remote environment doesn't mean hiring needs to stop. In fact, hiring remotely can be a huge benefit should you choose to stick with the remote model. With remote, companies can hire from anywhere and have access to the best talent, regardless of location. When moving candidates through the hiring process remotely, it's important to detail exactly how they will join the interview (i.e. phone call or video call), who they will be interviewing with, and how long they should expect the interview to take. Help candidates think through any logistics to consider. For example, if it's a video call, make sure to have a good internet and set up in a room with minimal distractions. Read this overview on hiring in an all-remote arena.

1. Compensation: Getting or keeping team members paid in a suddenly all-remote environment requires planning with your finance team, especially if foreign currencies come into play. Read this overview on compensation for more information, which includes details on location and other factors.

Internships: Finding, recruiting and retaining interns when shifted to a suddenly all-remote environment can be challenging, but not impossible. Read this guide on internships for more information.

## The upside of disruption

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Not all disruptions are bad. Often, they tend to spark new ways of thinking that spawn innovations. Consider the following benefits from a people perspective:

1. Focus on Results: Without the minor issues as distractions, people professionals can focus on encouraging productive behaviors and helping team leaders drive results. This unleashing of people professionals to focus on business goals can have a meaningful impact on job satisfaction.

1. Leadership: People teams can help advance leaders, edit succession plans, and prepare for the future away from the everyday noise that a traditional office might mask. Specifically, they can identify leaders who are most likely to thrive in suddenly remote environments, including those who are particularly self-aware, demonstrate empathy, embrace a servant-leader mindset, and possess a bias for documentation.

1. Competitive Advantage: Assuming competitors don't shift to an all-remote arena, there's a huge competitive advantage to finding and retaining talent in all-remote environments. Geographic limitations to talent acquisition disappear overnight as do retention fears of star performers getting poached for relocation. All-remote can be a big boost to your brand.

## The bottom line

People teams which embrace the suddenly all-remote shift for its upside potential rather than its downside possibilities are likely to provide greater support. By thinking creatively, embracing ambiguity, maintaining flexibility, and focusing on behaviors and results, people leaders will have a central role in managing the shift and optimizing it over time.

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## SECTION: company/culture/inclusion/2023-dib-report.md

Everyone means everyone

Inclusion has always been at the heart of GitLab. In fact, we founded the company with a mission to make it so that everyone can contribute and we know that "everyone" is a powerful word. We don't take that lightly.

"Everyone" is a promise to honor the experiences of each person, their individuality, and their voice. More importantly, it's a commitment to help them harness that individuality, to make their uniqueness essential. That goes for our users and our team members. Because when we can channel each person's experience—that is, when we can add everyone into our product—then we truly become innovators. And by prioritizing Diversity, Inclusion, and Belonging (DIB), we lay the groundwork to multiply our capabilities.

To put it simply, we need the contributions of everyone in order to transform the industry, empower our team members, and help our users change the world.

From our CEO

> To be updated

GitLab's DIB vision

Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging has been a core at GitLab since the organization began. Our vision in FY24 is a future where the Diversity, Inclusion, and Belonging value empowers everyone to contribute.

> When I started at GitLab a little over a year ago, I was

> encouraged by what existed around Diversity Inclusion and  
> Belonging. We had executive leadership backing our DIB  
> initiatives, a number of Team Member Resource Groups  
> (TMRGs) to support our workforce and Key Performance  
> Indicators (KPI) focused on DIB representation. We also had  
> areas where we could make a bigger difference: working with  
> our leaders on embedding DIB into their divisions in meaningful  
> ways that reflect their accountability to DIB as a value.  
> Reimagining our TMRGs to reflect our global workforce and  
> utilizing them to both engage and retain our team members  
> through dedicated programs, and educating our leaders on the  
> representation in their divisions and enlisting their support for  
> our programs. We also looked to refocus our efforts on  
> ensuring our workforce is representative of the community and  
> customers we serve at every level of the organization.

>

> I am encouraged by the advancements we've made in these  
> areas. Throughout this report, we'll share more details by  
> focusing on our workforce, our workplace and  
> how we have made progress through collaborative  
> partnerships both internally with our talent team and externally  
> with organizations dedicated to the education and progression  
> of our underrepresented groups in the tech industry.

>

> DIB at GitLab in FY23 was focused on continuing the mission  
> of diversity, inclusion, and belonging, where, like our company's  
> mission, we believe in a world where everyone can contribute.  
> And we don't just believe in that world, we're building it with  
> DIB as a core value. A world where everyone has a voice and is  
> empowered to show up as their full selves each and every day.

>

> Our vision in FY24 is a future where the Diversity, Inclusion,  
> and Belonging value empowers everyone to contribute. We're  
> excited to be highlighting this important work and sharing this  
> report, so you can find out more about GitLab Diversity,  
> Inclusion, and Belonging in practice, our team members'  
> experiences, and where we still have work to do.

- Sherida McMullan, Vice President of Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging

The people who make us proud

People make our product go; more specifically, unique people make our product go. And we know that because we've seen it work. We've seen how individual contributors change the game, dream up new product features, and breathe life into our culture.

Giving everyone the power to contribute starts with making our group of team members as representative of everyone as possible. It starts with putting our words into action, and we're proud of who we've become and the team we've put together.

How we fulfill our DIB workforce goals

Building a diverse and inclusive workplace is one of our top priorities, and it requires effort and a dedicated effort across the company. We're committed to that investment, and will continue to improve year over year.

At GitLab we are building an inclusive workplace by:

- Increasing our underrepresented group representation across all job grades, exceeding our CTO and CEO aspirational quarterly goals focused on URG management and senior leadership
- Establishing 3 new Team Member Resource Groups (TMRGs) focused on inclusion and belonging: GitLab Caregivers, Global Voices, and Black@GitLab

- > It's wonderful to work for a company that accelerates me as a woman,
- > a working mother, as well as being a part of a team. It makes me feel
- > great. I feel very included. I feel like my voice is respected and I
- > feel that I can achieve anything here at GitLab.

- April Marks, GitLab Strategic Account Leader

The story our DIB data tells about our people

For FY23 (February 2022 to January 2023), our goal was to continue building a diverse team of top talent that we retain and grow. We're proud of the progress we've made in doing that.

Here are a few of the stats that indicate our current representation:

- 31% of our workforce is women
- 35% of our management staff are women
- 37% of global senior leadership at GitLab are women
- 17% of our workforce is comprised of URGs
- 13% of our management team is comprised of URGs
- 13% of our senior leadership group is comprised of URGs

.68% of GitLab's management team identifies as non-binary

6.6 percentage point decrease in regrettable underrepresented group (URG) attrition relative to a year ago.

You can see all of our team member representation data [here](#).

Building a workplace where everyone belongs

At GitLab, we're building a culture where everyone belongs and everyone

can contribute. Our ability to do that rests upon listening and using every available resource to take action that results in change. When we do that, we create a workplace where everyone feels valued, a place where team members know they'll be accepted and want to come to work.

- > Many companies claim to encourage professional growth, but GitLab is
- > the first company where I've worked that I feel actually is committed
- > to this promise.

- Yimei Lin, GitLab Senior Account Executive

#### Our culture of listening

A big part of GitLab's engagement strategy involves collaboration across many teams and functions. Our centralized People Communications & Engagement team coordinates team member communications, engagement resources, team member listening, and maintaining leadership resources that allow managers at GitLab to lead engaged teams.

GitLab runs an annual engagement survey and supplements that annual survey with at least one additional survey that broadly gauges team member sentiment. For the past three years, we've taken part in the Great Place to Work survey to understand team member perceptions. In FY23, we achieved an 82% participation rate and an overall 'favorable' engagement score of 81%. We scored 8% higher than our New Tech peer group, which consists of ~150 fast growing and disruptive tech companies with over 1000 total team members each. These results show that GitLab is an industry leader from an engagement perspective.

As an organization that values transparency, we publish all of our engagement survey results in our public handbook. This allows both team members and prospective candidates to get a view into our culture:  
<<https://handbook.gitlab.com/handbook/people-group/engagement/>>

#### Our culture of action

- > As a company that values transparency, publishing our 2023 Diversity,
- > Inclusion, and Belonging report is an exciting milestone that highlights
- > both our progress and areas to further build a more representative and
- > equitable GitLab. Being the new executive sponsor of our Caregivers Team
- > Member Resource Group, I'm excited to share my experience with other
- > caregivers at GitLab and ensure we are exploring the best ways to meet
- > the needs of our team members who are caring for others.

- Wendy Nice Barnes, GitLab Chief People Officer

Many of the elements that have enhanced our DIB culture have come from the insights of our team members, the expansion of our DIB staff, and the never-ending question: what can we do better?

Here are a few components of GitLab's DIB value that we've put into action.

### Team Member Resource Groups (TMRGs)

TMRGs are voluntary, team member-led groups focused on fostering diversity, inclusion and belonging within GitLab. TMRGs build a sense of belonging through team members: togetherness, camaraderie, and connections. These groups are open to all members of the GitLab community.

Within these groups, members can experience:

- Reverse AMAs: Ask Me Anything Q&A with our Executive Group and team members.
- Stay interviews: Small cohort conversations with Executive Group leaders and our underrepresented groups with the goal of gaining valuable insights to ensure we are fostering an inclusive culture where all team members can thrive.
- Sales sponsorship pilot: A nine-month program that paired our senior CRO leaders with underrepresented team members to help create pathways, visibility, and advocacy to assist with progression within Sales.
- TMRG Leadership Recognition Program: A bonus provided to team members leading our TMRGs or DIB-focused groups to recognize great work being done to support the DIB strategy and DIB Team and embedding the DIB value at GitLab
- DIB Speaker Series: These are speakers, panels, or workshops with leaders internally and externally from a variety of communities. These events provide educational opportunities and inspire allyship with underrepresented groups.
- Executive (VP+) sponsorship: The role is to support the development of the TMRG, provide advocacy at the leadership level, connect the TMRG to GitLab's mission and goals, and provide advocacy to TMRG leaders.
- TMRG community Slack spaces: TMRGs create safe spaces to connect.

> As the Executive Sponsor of the Black@GitLab TMRG, I advocate for the  
> team member group and make sure that it's happening at the executive  
> level as well as across the company. My goal is also to provide  
> visibility into what's happening so members of the TMRG can be truly  
> connected to the company.

- David DeSanto, GitLab Chief Product Officer

### Sponsorships

We've carefully selected and partnered with organizations that enhance and promote our DIB practice both internally and publicly. These sponsorships afford us additional resources to magnify our culture for existing team members and raise awareness for our DIB emphasis in our talent pipeline.

A few of our sponsorships include:

- Black is Tech 2022
- Dev/Color in Motion 2022, San Francisco
- Girl Develop It Career Fair 2022

- Rails Girls Warsaw 2022, Poland
- Speaker Engagements at:
  - VentureFizz Career Progression Panel 2022
  - Women in Sales Everywhere (WISE) - Making the Most of Mentorship
  - WISE - Burnout: What is it and how do we manage it?
  - WISE - EOY Reflections: Preparing for 2023

## Leadership Council

### Our Leadership DIB Council

consists of 13 Director+ leaders representing every division across all regions. Their task is to assist the DIB Team in implementing the corporate DIB strategy and provide insights to the DIB Team on the division's strategic initiatives. More specifically, the Leadership DIB Council is responsible for:

- Aligning DIB initiatives with business goals
- Providing division and/or geographic insights to the DIB Team
- Representing DIB in the Executive Group
- Actively advocating, challenging norms, and iterating to ensure that DIB remains top of mind at GitLab

## The future of Diversity, Inclusion, and Belonging

DIB helps us accelerate innovation, attract top talent, and deepen team member engagement. And we can't make everyone a contributor if we aren't connecting with every community. So it goes to say that DIB is an integral part of our future—not only as a people-centric practice but as a key contributor to our success in the DevSecOps industry.

So what does success look like? Of course, it includes continued improvement of our underrepresented group representation data, at the senior levels of the organization, beyond the current marks. It includes continuing to create new ways to make every team member feel comfortable to participate, empowered to excel, and open to express their authentic selves.

But DIB success also takes the form of increased market share, skyrocketing innovation, and greater customer sentiment. As we mentioned before, including everyone only makes GitLab better, and the effect we have on the market is a direct reflection of our focus on DIB.

- > DIB has significantly evolved throughout GitLab's history and I am
- > encouraged by the support for TMRGs, for example, the Women's TMRG has
- > grown from 19 members to 246 members today. As DIB evolves, there's still
- > a need for more women in senior leadership and I'd like to see DIB be a
- > part of every E-Group-level KPI and OKR.

- Kyla Gradin-Dahl, Area Sales Manager, U.S. West

## How we continue to boost DIB at GitLab

- > With GitLab due to our values being a 'living' thing, what DIB means
- > really changed · we are better at everything due to DIB evolving with our
- > growth. Ensuring that we practice DIB as we grow further · every level in
- > the company has to act every day and not only say that they support it.

- Marin Jankovski, Senior Director of Infrastructure, Platforms

## Enhancing corporate sustainability

Environmental Social Governance (ESG) practices, although newly formalized in GitLab's strategy, have been embedded in our work culture since its inception. Deeply integrated into the business philosophy, GitLab's ESG strategy is driven by our values of Collaboration, Results, Efficiency, Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging, Iteration, and Transparency (CREDIT).

The ESG Team created and continuously maintains GitLab's corporate sustainability strategy and programs. This includes creating and managing ESG disclosures and public ESG reports, identifying and prioritizing key issues to advance GitLab's social and environmental goals, and creating partnerships with nonprofit organizations that support GitLab's values and mission. Read GitLab's FY23 ESG report for more information.

## Partnerships

We will continue to focus on strategic partnerships, content, and engagement platforms, focused on:

- DIB-first brand presence to increase brand recognition amongst underrepresented groups
- Providing increased opportunities to GitLab team members to engage with external communities focused on supporting underrepresented groups
- Increasing candidate engagement and attraction amongst underrepresented groups

## Continuing to evolve our approach to talent acquisition

While FY23 was rooted in building the foundational elements and introducing aspirational goals in Talent Acquisition, the year ahead will be highlighted by embedding inclusive hiring into our metrics, definitions of success, and best practices. Instead of adding "diversity" as a layer or lens to see Talent Acquisition (TA) through, we are setting out to make DIB a foundational ingredient in everything that we do. Through a continued partnership with the DIB, People Business Partners, and Data Analytics teams, we are focusing specifically on casting a wide net across multiple sources to increase representation at the candidate pipeline stage. While we establish a strong pipeline and evolve our best practices, we are also strategically planning other areas of outsized impact for the business and maturing our data to ensure we can make data-driven decisions through this work. Some specific areas of focus



will include:

- Partner on establishing strategic company-level OKRs
- Launch our vision, mission, and 3-year TA strategy with inclusive hiring practices integrated throughout
- Focus pipeline building across a wide range of sources to ensure talent attraction efforts reach underrepresented groups

Examining where we fall short

In the coming years, we will break down our populations into tech and non-tech to ensure we are further examining where we may have gaps.

Continued focus on underrepresented group representation

We will continue to increase underrepresented group representation across all job grades, aiming to exceed our CTO and CEO aspirational quarterly goals focused on URG management and senior leadership.

Focusing on retaining team members

We will continue to decrease regrettable underrepresented group (URG) attrition.

Managerial development

At GitLab we realize our managers are a critical population so we launched Elevate, our leadership development course, to upskill managers and embed inclusive behaviors aligned to our DIB value into each module. In addition to Elevate, we have a goal that our managers take a separate neurodiversity training and have exceeded our initial goal of 30% completions in FY23. We are striving to have all of our managers complete the training in FY24.

Creating a more equitable world beyond GitLab

In September 2022, the GitLab Foundation launched with a mission to improve people's lifetime earnings through access to opportunities, and a vision of a world in which one million more people can afford a better life. The GitLab Foundation was formed by GitLab Inc. as part of its mission to create a world in which everyone can contribute. GitLab leadership believed it was important to support organizations that could further this goal on a global scale. When GitLab Inc. went public in October 2021, it dedicated 1% of its shares to further this aim.

The GitLab Foundation is currently funded by GitLab Inc. and its CEO, Sid Sijbrandij. The GitLab Foundation is an independent nonprofit entity and its operations are autonomous from GitLab Inc.

To learn more, visit the GitLab Foundation.

> The GitLab Foundation is accelerating ways for people to gain the skills  
> and opportunities needed to increase their lifetime earnings. Our vision  
> is a world in which one million more people can afford a better life. As  
> people thrive, so will their communities and economies.

- Ellie Bertani, President & CEO, GitLab Foundation

## Conclusion

As we work toward achieving our mission of making it so that everyone can contribute, DIB will remain a key focus for GitLab. Over the last year we faced a number of external headwinds that impacted our global workforce in different ways. We dealt with an economic downturn, the fallout from Russia's invasion of Ukraine and the resulting war, the uncertainty of COVID, the uncertainty of political movements across the globe, and the reality that these factors weigh heavily on our team members. With DIB as one of our core values, we've been able to make progress in spite of these challenges and are more committed than ever to ensuring GitLab creates a workplace and community where everyone can contribute and everyone is welcome.

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## Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging at GitLab

Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging is fundamental to the success of GitLab. We include it in every way possible and in all that we do. We strive for a transparent environment where all globally dispersed voices are heard and welcomed. We strive for an environment where people can show up as their full selves each day and can contribute to their best ability. And with over 100,000 organizations utilizing GitLab across the globe, we strive for a team that is representative of our users.

Diversity complements our other values, specifically Collaboration, Efficiency and Results. And diversity in our leadership supports innovation, promotes better decision making and improves financial results.

## GitLab's Diversity Inclusion and Belonging Mission

- Mission: At GitLab, we believe everyone can contribute and the Diversity Inclusion and Belonging Team are building scalable strategies based on our acronym, A.D.A.P.T. which stands for Action, Doing Good in the communities we serve, holding ourselves Accountable and creating

equitable Policies in a Transparent environment. We are focused on helping to build high performing, customer centric teams by expanding, establishing, embedding our DIB (/handbook/values/diversity-inclusion). Just as DIB is a journey, our acronym, A.D.A.P.T. mirrors the agility required throughout that journey.

- Action - Action puts intentionality into how we attract, progress and retain our team members as well as engage with our customers and the open source community.
- Do Good - We "Do Good" by providing avenues for GitLab & team members to meaningfully contribute to our community and society.
- Accountable - We hold ourselves Accountable in the commitments we make as well as being Answerable for the outcome.
- Policies - We build scalable Policies to govern our work and actionable processes which inform our program development and execution.
- Transparent - Transparency is the T in our GitLab CREDIT values and how we operate within DIB ensuring that our internal efforts are reflected externally.

### GitLab's Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging Vision

Vision: The Diversity Inclusion and Belonging value empowers everyone to contribute.

### GitLab's definition of Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging

The phrase "Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging" (or DIB) refers to the terminology for the initiative to create a diverse workforce and an environment where everyone can be their full selves.

Diversity refers to characteristics of the people who make up GitLab and how they identify. Race, gender, age, ethnicity, religion, national origin, disability, sexual orientation are some examples of how the data might be categorized when looking at GitLab's diversity. Sometimes we can see things that make us diverse and sometimes we can't. We believe that a company composed of a diverse group of people may lead to diverse opinions and ideas which, if productively engaged with, can build innovation.

GitLab uses the term "underrepresented" and it is meant to be a way of recognizing that we need more of what we do not have so that we can be at our best.

The context is "at GitLab" or "in a specific department or team at GitLab."

This term is generally used in the context of reporting on how GitLab is working on understanding and improving the sourcing, interviewing, hiring, and retention of those who either want to work or currently work at GitLab.

- A single person should not be referred to as a "diverse person" or a "diversity hire" which would imply they are not included in the current community or that they are only employed because of a factor that is not directly related to their skills and their ability to do their job.
- People should not be singled out or "othered" by labels with cold terminology in personal interactions.

For additional information about how GitLab uses this data to make progress, please see "select underrepresented group"

Inclusion is the ability to recognize, respect, and value differences in those around us. It focuses on the action and understanding of what makes us diverse and working towards building a diverse team and creating welcoming workplace. It requires skills such as empathy, openness, listening, etc. This lays the foundation of an inclusive mindset. The foundation of understanding gives way to the actions and being intentional about creating policies and practices that embrace diversity that in the end change the overall company culture to create an environment of inclusion. Inclusion also means being aware of both positive and negative biases and how those biases impact who we hire, work with, and retain.

GitLab believes that many perspectives coming together creates a more innovative environment to work in with more satisfied team members, leading to a better product and increased profitability.

Belonging is a feeling that your insights and contributions are valued. It goes back to team members feeling they can bring their full selves to work. It's not enough to simply include people to have a "seat at the table", but it's important to amplify everyone's voices, remove barriers and appreciate each others for their unique backgrounds.

Embracing inclusion may increase the sense of belonging. Team members become more engaged and are invested in the work they are doing, because they are able to see themselves in the work being accomplished with the company overall.

We believe in empowering team members to get their work done efficiently and collaboratively by establishing clear DRIs for all our work. DRIs do not owe anyone an explanation for their decisions, but DRIs can still acknowledge input by closing an issue and marking it Won't Do or commenting on an issue acknowledging that they have read all the comments.

All team members don't have to agree on the best course of action- we can disagree, commit, and disagree- but everyone can contribute and it is on the DRI to acknowledge those.

Some other ways we actively cultivate a sense of Belonging at GitLab include creating and cultivating allies, welcoming family members in the background of a call, and sharing negative feedback in 1-1 settings.

A good way to look at Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging is:

- Diversity
  - diversity dimensions/layers that make people who they are
  - knowing the layers and having a seat at the table
- Inclusion
  - having a voice
  - feeling empowered to use your voice
- Belonging
  - acknowledgment of your voice being heard
  - the feeling of being a part of something
  - creating an environment where team members feel secure to be themselves

#### Examples of Select Underrepresented Groups

An underrepresented group describes a subset of a population that holds a smaller percentage within a significant subgroup than the subset holds in the general population. The accepted definition of "underrepresented minorities" from the National Science Foundation and other

major research institutions focuses on racial and ethnic groups whose representation in a profession is significantly below their representation in the general population. Populations whose representation in tech roles has been historically low. Tech roles are based on Federal Employer Information Report EEO-1 skill designations. At GitLab, this includes all technical roles across the company, such as Engineering & Product.

At GitLab, we consider the following groups to be underrepresented groups:

- Women - Globally
- Women in Management - Globally
- Women in Senior Leadership - Globally
- Black/African American - United States
- Black/African American in Management - United States
- Black/African American in Senior Leadership - United States
- Hispanic/Latino - United States
- Hispanic/Latino in Management - United States
- Hispanic/Latino in Senior Leadership - United States
- Indigenous Peoples/Alaska Native - United States
- Indigenous Peoples/Alaska Native in Management - United States
- Indigenous Peoples/Alaska Native in Senior Leadership - United States
- Hawaiian/Pacific Islander - United States
- Hawaiian/Pacific Islander in Management - United States
- Hawaiian/Pacific Islander in Senior Leadership - United States

Due to data and or legal limitations, this is not an exhaustive list of all of our underrepresented groups. Those with disabilities, those that identify as LGBTQIA+, those who choose not to disclose as well as underrepresented ethnicities outside of the US, etc.

The DIB Team is actively working on finding data sets outside the US and inclusion metrics for underrepresented groups we cannot report on as team member representation.

Of Note: Management refers to Team Members who are People Managers, whereas Leadership denotes Team Members who are in Director-level positions and above.

Source: GitLab's People Analytics Team, WorkDay

Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging Team

- Sherida McMullan - Vice President, Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging
- Liam McNally - Manager, Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging
- Naomi Johnson - DIB Business Partner

Values

Inclusive teams are naturally more engaged, collaborative and innovative. We aim to align our values to be reflective of our company wide commitment to fostering a diverse and inclusive environment.

In addition, the very nature of our company is to facilitate and foster inclusion. We believe in asynchronous communication, we allow flexible work hours. GitLab team members are

encouraged to work when and where they are most comfortable.

Fully distributed and completely connected

The GitLab team is fully distributed across the globe, providing our team the opportunity to connect with each others cultures, celebrations and unique traditions.  
We collaborate professionally and connect personally!

Our unique all-remote team opens our door to everyone.  
Candidates are not limited by geography and we champion this approach, to the extent that it's possible, for all companies!

By having no offices and allowing each GitLab team member to work and live where they are most comfortable, GitLab offers a uniquely inclusive culture.

- All-remote means that you will not sacrifice career advancement by working outside of the office, as even GitLab executives are fully remote.
- All-remote creates a workplace where caregivers, individuals with physical disabilities, etc. are not disadvantaged for being unable to regularly commute into an office.
- GitLab's approach to Spending Company Money enables all team members to create a work environment uniquely tailored for them.
- All-remote enables those who must relocate frequently for family and personal reasons to take their career with them.
- All-remote allows movement and relocation to physical settings that contribute to an individual's health (e.g. moving to a location with an improved air quality index).

Learn more about GitLab's all-remote culture.

GitLab team member data

Please see our identity data.

What we are doing with Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging

Talent Acquisition initiatives

This page provides an overview of our Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging Talent Acquisition initiatives.

Engineering Initiatives

This page provides an overview of our Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging Engineering initiatives

Sales Initiatives

- TBD

IamRemarkable Workshop

IamRemarkable is a workshop created by Google. The initiative aims to individuals to celebrate

their achievements in the workplace and beyond, and to challenge perceptions around self-promotion.

## Logistics

At GitLab we launched the IamRemarkable workshop in April 2021, and aim to continue with two workshops per quarter on an ongoing basis. Before the start of each quarter, a quarterly workshop planning issue will be opened where team members have the opportunity to volunteer to participate. Slots will be allocated on first come first serve basis.

The workshops are kept to a max of 15 team members to generate more comfort and psychological safety within the group, in addition to providing everyone with an opportunity to share and contribute to discussion. Each workshop is two hours in duration. Due to the personal nature of the workshop, we do not record IamRemarkable sessions.

## Facilitators

Currently, we have three GitLab team members who are certified to facilitate the IamRemarkable workshop:

- 1. Giuliana Lucchesi
- 1. Terri Chu
- 1. Gosia Ksionek

In order to more efficiently scale this initiative at GitLab, we would love to have more facilitators join us! Anyone can register to become a facilitator. As soon as you have been certified, feel free to add your name to the list of facilitators above.

## Inclusive benefits

We list our Pregnancy & Maternity Care publicly so people don't have to ask for them during interviews. In addition GitLab offers an Employee Assistance Program to all team members via Modern Health, a one-stop shop for all tools related to mental well-being and self-improvement.

## Inclusive language

In our GitLab Values we list: 'Use inclusive language. For example, prefer "Hi everybody" or "Hi people" to "Hi guys".'

## TMRGs - Team Member Resource Groups

We have created several TMRGs and welcome interest in creating new ones. Would you like to sign up for an Team Member Resource Group, start an TMRG, or just learn more? See our TMRG Guide.

## Military veterans and spouses

GitLab welcomes military veterans from around the world, as well as military spouses, to learn more about life at GitLab and to apply for vacancies. We recognize the values gained from military experience, and we foster an inclusive atmosphere to thrive in when returning to civilian life.

Our all-remote culture provides an ideal work environment for military veterans and spouses. By empowering team members to live and work where they are most comfortable, veterans and spouses can work in a safe, nurturing environment that they choose and design.

We encourage military veterans and spouses to read testimonials from GitLab team members to understand the benefits of all-remote when joining the workforce following military service. We are committed to our Military Leave policy.

GitLab is actively iterating within Diversity, Inclusion & Belonging and Talent Acquisition to ensure that additional underrepresented groups are pursued, embraced, and positioned for success.

### Disability Inclusion

GitLab welcomes all types of team members, including any that may choose to identify as ones that currently have or were previously diagnosed as having a disability. In our HRIS (Human Resource Information System) Workday, on the Job tab page, in the Equal Employment Opportunity section, we have a field titled Disability Status that we ask our team members to complete during the onboarding process.

The reason we ask is because it is a legal requirement in the United States under Section 503 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, as we are a Federal contractor and are required to ask employees to voluntarily self-identify if they have a disability or have ever had a disability, and to provide equal employment opportunity to qualified people with disabilities.

The options of this field are:

- Yes, I have or previously had a disability
- No, I do not have a disability
- Prefer Not to Answer

If you are unsure how to answer, please review our Individual with Disabilities Policy.

At GitLab, we are proud to make reasonable accommodations to the known disability of a team member. Please review the reasonable accommodation handbook section if you need a reasonable accommodation due to your disability. Find more information on GitLab Inc's Individuals with Disabilities policy.

### United States Veteran Inclusion

The United States Office of Federal Contract Compliance Programs (OFCCP) enforces the affirmative action provisions of the Vietnam Era Veterans' Readjustment Assistance Act of 1974. This law, sometimes referred to as VEVRAA, requires employers doing business with the United States Federal Government (such as our GitLab Federal entity) to take steps to recruit, hire and promote protected veterans. It also makes it illegal to discriminate against protected veterans when making employment decisions on hiring, firing, pay, benefits, job assignments, promotions, layoffs, training, and other employment-related activities. Under VEVRAA, a veteran who served on active duty in the U.S. military and was discharged or release from service under conditions other than dishonorable may be classified as one or more of the four Protected Veteran categories:



- Disabled Veteran A veteran who served on active duty in the U.S. military and is entitled to disability compensation (or who but for the receipt of military retired pay would be entitled to disability compensation) under laws administered by the Secretary of Veterans Affairs, or was discharged or released from active duty because of a service-connected disability.
- Recently Separated Veteran A veteran separated during the three-year period beginning on the date of the veteran's discharge or release from active duty in the U.S. military.
- Armed Forces Service Medal Veteran A veteran who, while serving on active duty in the U.S. military, participated in a U.S. military operation that received an Armed Forces service medal.
- Other Protected Veteran (listed in Workday as Active Duty Wartime or Campaign Badge Veteran)  
A veteran who served on active duty in the U.S. military during a war, or in a campaign or expedition for which a campaign badge was authorized under the laws administered by the Department of Defense.

In our HRIS (Hum